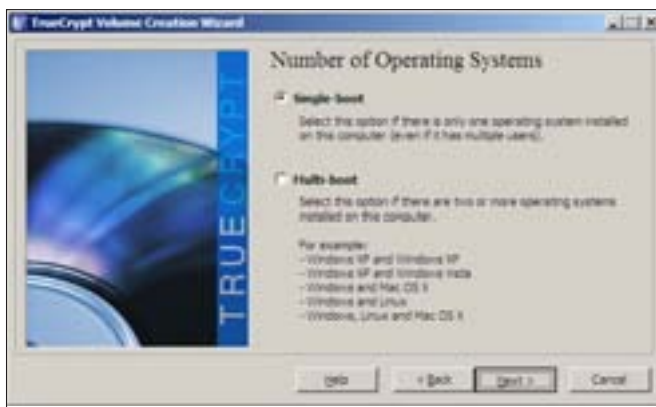


very important to securely format such drives. There have been many cases of data thefts recovering sensitive materials from hard drives sold off in auctions. Deleting the data from the recycle bin is not enough, or using shift+delete does not really delete the data. What these operations do is remove the index of the particular files from the index. A file recovery tool, as demonstrated above, can recover files from such drives. The data will remain in the hard drive for long periods of time, especially if the files are small in size.

Software for securely deleting data are available. These software delete the file from the index, as well as replace the actual data on the drive with pseudorandom data. The physical location of the data on the disk is overwritten, so the chances of recovering the data is greatly reduced. We will be showing how to use two free programs for deleting data, but there are more available. These are both freeware. FreeCommander is an alternative to Windows Explorer, and has a number of extra features. FreeCommander securely deletes data quickly and easily. Eraser is another application, and it can be configured to overwrite the data many times over. Eraser is the more secure and robust file shredding application, but is also far more time consuming because of the numerous overwrite runs required.

Free Commander is a free file browser that makes exploring the file system easier. Folders show up with sizes, and there is



Single or Multi boot